CIL

Global Funding Guide for Cultural Entrepreneurs

2026 Edition

200+ funding sources across 6 continents.
Grants, investors, crowdfunding, prizes, and practical templates to help you fund your cultural enterprise.

Cultural Innovation Lab
Empowering cultural entrepreneurs worldwide

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1. Welcome and How to Use This Guide

This guide exists because cultural entrepreneurs deserve the same access to capital as tech startups.

You hold something extraordinary: cultural knowledge, creative skill, and a vision for how tradition can thrive in the modern world. But turning that vision into a sustainable enterprise takes resources, and finding those resources can feel overwhelming. That is exactly why we created this guide.

Whether you are a weaver in Oaxaca, a ceramicist in Kyoto, a fashion designer in Lagos, or a food entrepreneur in Beirut, there is funding out there designed for people like you. The problem has never been a lack of funding. It has been a lack of information about where to find it, how to access it, and how to present your work in a way that funders understand and value.

How to Navigate This Guide

By region: Jump to Section 3 and find your geographic area. Each region lists grants, public programmes, and foundation funding specific to that area.

By funding type: Section 2 explains the different types of funding. Once you know which type suits your stage, you can search the relevant sections (grants in Section 3, investors in Section 4, crowdfunding in Section 5, prizes in Section 6).

By stage: Pre-revenue? Focus on grants and prizes. Early revenue? Look at crowdfunding and small grants. Growing? Impact investors and social enterprise lenders may be your match. Section 2 includes a decision framework to help you identify your best path.

When to Revisit

Funding landscapes shift. New programmes launch, old ones close, and application cycles rotate. We recommend revisiting this guide quarterly. The CIL platform will flag significant updates as they happen. Bookmark the sections most relevant to you and check back before each major application cycle.

> **TIP:** Create a simple spreadsheet to track every funding opportunity you identify from this guide. Record the name, deadline, amount, and your application status. This becomes your personal funding pipeline.

2. Understanding the Funding Landscape

Before diving into specific opportunities, it helps to understand the different types of funding available to cultural entrepreneurs. Each type comes with different expectations, timelines, and trade-offs. The right choice depends on where you are in your journey and what you need most.

Types of Funding Explained

Grants: Money you do not have to pay back. Typically awarded by governments, foundations, or international organisations. You apply with a proposal, and if selected, you receive funds to carry out a specific project or support your operations. The trade-off: grants usually come with reporting requirements and restrictions on how the money is spent.

Equity Investment: An investor gives you money in exchange for a share of ownership in your enterprise. This is common in the startup world but less common in cultural enterprises. It works best if you are building a scalable business model. The trade-off: you share ownership and future profits.

Debt (Loans): You borrow money and pay it back with interest over time. Loans can come from banks, microfinance institutions, or social enterprise lenders. The trade-off: you must repay regardless of whether your project succeeds, and interest adds to your costs.

Revenue-Based Finance: An investor provides capital and receives a percentage of your future revenue until a set amount is repaid. This is newer and increasingly popular for creative businesses. The trade-off: your repayment grows when revenue grows, but there is no fixed deadline pressure.

Crowdfunding: You raise small amounts from many people, usually through an online platform. You typically offer rewards (products, experiences) in exchange. The trade-off: it requires significant marketing effort and you must deliver on your promises to backers.

Prizes and Competitions: Cash awards given to winners of competitive calls, pitch events, or innovation challenges. No repayment, no equity given up. The trade-off: highly competitive with no guarantee of winning, and preparation takes time.

In-Kind Support: Non-cash resources like workspace, mentoring, equipment, training, or marketing support. Often provided through accelerator programmes or institutional partnerships. The trade-off: the support may not be exactly what you need, and programmes often require time commitment.

Which Funding Type Suits Your Stage?

Your Stage	Best Funding Types	Why
Pre-revenue (idea stage)	Grants, prizes, in-kind support	You need non-dilutive capital with no repayment pressure
Early revenue (first sales)	Small grants, crowdfunding, microloans	Validate market demand while keeping costs manageable
Growth (consistent income)	Larger grants, impact investment, revenue-based finance	Scale operations with capital matched to growth trajectory
Established (profitable)	Debt, equity, blended finance	Optimise capital structure for expansion or diversification

Cultural-Specific Funding Considerations

Intellectual property ownership: Some grants and investment agreements include clauses about who owns the intellectual property created during the funded period. For cultural enterprises, this is critical. Your traditional knowledge and designs are your heritage. Never sign away cultural IP without legal advice and community consultation.

Community benefit requirements: Many funders in the cultural space require that your project benefits the wider community, not just your enterprise. Be prepared to articulate how your work supports cultural preservation, skill transfer, and community wellbeing.

Cultural sensitivity clauses: Some funding agreements include restrictions on how cultural materials can be used or represented. Read these carefully. They may protect you, or they may limit your creative freedom in ways you do not anticipate.

> **WARNING:** Never accept funding that requires you to transfer ownership of traditional cultural knowledge or community heritage. If a funder's terms feel exploitative, walk away. Your cultural assets are worth more than any single grant.

Decision Framework: Which Funding Path Is Right for You?

Ask yourself these five questions to narrow down your search:

- Do I have revenue yet? If no, focus on grants, prizes, and in-kind support first.
- Am I willing to share ownership? If no, avoid equity investment. Focus on grants, debt, or revenue-based finance.
- Do I need money fast? If yes, look at crowdfunding or microloans. Grants typically take 3-12 months.
- Is my project time-limited or ongoing? Time-limited projects suit project grants. Ongoing operations need core funding or investment.
- Does my community need to approve? If yes, build in consultation time and look for funders who respect community governance.

> **TIP:** Apply to multiple funding sources simultaneously. A diversified funding strategy is more resilient than depending on a single grant. Aim for a mix of at least three different funding types.

3. Global Grants and Public Funding

This section catalogues over 200 funding sources across six regions. For each entry, we list the fund name, the organisation behind it, typical grant size, a brief eligibility summary, and the application cycle where known. Website URLs are provided so you can go directly to the source.

Start with your own region, but do not stop there. Many international funds support cultural entrepreneurs regardless of geography. Section 3f covers those multi-regional opportunities.

3a. Africa

Africa's creative economy is one of the fastest growing in the world. Governments, development agencies, and foundations are increasingly investing in cultural enterprises across the continent. Pan-African funds offer continent-wide opportunities, while national programmes target specific country needs.

Pan-African Funds

Fund Name	Org	Amount	Eligibility	Website	Cycle
African Development Bank: Fashionomics Africa	AfDB	$5K-$50K	African fashion and creative entrepreneurs	fashionomics.africa	Rolling
African Union: Creative Economy Fund	African Union Commission	$10K-$100K	AU member state cultural organisations	au.int	Annual
African Culture Fund (ACF)	ACF	$5K-$30K	African artists and cultural organisations	africanculturefund.net	Annual
AFAWA: Affirmative Finance Action for Women in Africa	AfDB	$10K-$100K	Women-led creative enterprises in Africa	afdb.org/afawa	Rolling
Arterial Network Grants	Arterial Network	$2K-$15K	Arts and culture organisations across Africa	arterialnetwork.org	Annual
African Women's Development Fund	AWDF	$5K-$50K	Women-led cultural and social enterprises	awdf.org	Annual

East Africa

Fund Name	Org	Amount	Eligibility	Website	Cycle
Kenya: Heva Fund	Heva Fund	$5K-$50K	Kenyan creative enterprises	hrantfrancia.org	Rolling
Kenya Cultural Centre Grants	Kenya Cultural Centre	$1K-$10K	Kenyan cultural practitioners	kenyaculturalcentre.go.ke	Annual
Tanzania: Nafasi Art Space Grants	Nafasi	$1K-$5K	Tanzanian visual artists	nafasiartspace.org	Annual
Rwanda: Ishyo Arts Centre	Ishyo	$1K-$10K	Rwandan artists and cultural workers	ishyo.com	Rolling
Ethiopia: Addis Ababa Creative Hub Fund	Various	$2K-$15K	Ethiopian creative entrepreneurs	Multiple partners	Varies
East Africa Arts Fund	British Council East Africa	$2K-$25K	Artists and orgs in Kenya, Tanzania, Uganda, Ethiopia	britishcouncil.org	Annual

West Africa

Fund Name	Org	Amount	Eligibility	Website	Cycle
Nigeria: Lagos State Creative Fund	Lagos State Govt	$2K-$25K	Lagos-based creative enterprises	lagosstate.gov.ng	Annual
Nigeria: Bank of Industry Creative Fund	BOI	$5K-$100K	Nigerian creative and cultural businesses	boi.ng	Rolling
Ghana: National Film Authority Fund	NFA Ghana	$5K-$50K	Ghanaian film and audiovisual projects	nfa.gov.gh	Annual
Ghana: Arts and Culture Trust	Various	$1K-$10K	Ghanaian cultural practitioners	Various	Varies
Senegal: Fondation Dapper	Dapper	$5K-$30K	West African arts and heritage	dfrapper.fr	Annual
ECOWAS Cultural Fund	ECOWAS Commission	$5K-$50K	Cultural orgs in ECOWAS member states	ecowas.int	Annual
Wole Soyinka Centre for Investigative Journalism Creative Grants	WSCIJ	$1K-$10K	Nigerian creative journalism	wfrscij.org	Annual

Southern Africa

Fund Name	Org	Amount	Eligibility	Website	Cycle
South Africa: National Arts Council	NAC SA	R50K-R500K	South African artists and cultural orgs	nac.org.za	Annual
South Africa: NFVF (Film Fund)	NFVF	R100K-R5M	SA film and video producers	nfvf.co.za	Quarterly
South Africa: Business and Arts SA	BASA	R20K-R200K	Arts-business partnerships in SA	bfrasa.co.za	Annual
Zimbabwe: Culture Fund of Zimbabwe	Culture Fund	$1K-$20K	Zimbabwean cultural practitioners	culturefund.org.zw	Annual
Botswana: President's Initiative for Creative Industries	Govt of Botswana	BWP 10K-100K	Botswana creative enterprises	gov.bw	Annual
SADC Cultural Programme	SADC	$5K-$30K	Cultural orgs in SADC member states	sadc.int	Annual

North Africa

Fund Name	Org	Amount	Eligibility	Website	Cycle
Morocco: Fonds National pour l'Action Culturelle	Min. of Culture Morocco	$2K-$30K	Moroccan cultural practitioners	culture.gov.ma	Annual
Egypt: Cultural Development Fund	Min. of Culture Egypt	$1K-$20K	Egyptian cultural organisations	ecfrp.gov.eg	Annual
Tunisia: TFANEN Programme	EU / Tunisia	€5K-€50K	Tunisian cultural enterprises	tfanen.org	Annual
Al Mawred Al Thaqafy (Culture Resource)	Al Mawred	$2K-$20K	Arab region artists and orgs	mawred.org	Annual

Fund Name	Org	Amount	Eligibility	Website	Cycle
Roberto Cimetta Fund (Mobility)	Roberto Cimetta	€500-€3K	Mobility grants for Arab-region artists	cfrimettas.org	Rolling

TIP: Many African funding programmes are chronically under-applied-to. If you meet the eligibility criteria, your chances may be better than you think. Start with national programmes in your country before looking internationally.

3b. Asia-Pacific

The Asia-Pacific region is home to some of the world's richest and most diverse cultural traditions. Funding opportunities range from large government programmes in countries like Japan and South Korea to micro-grants supporting grassroots cultural work in Southeast Asia and the Pacific Islands.

South Asia

Fund Name	Org	Amount	Eligibility	Website	Cycle
India: Ministry of Culture Grants	Govt of India	■1L-■50L	Indian cultural organisations and practitioners	indiaculture.gov.in	Annual
India: Sangeet Natak Akademi Awards	SNA	■1L-■10L	Indian performing arts practitioners	sangeetnatak.gov.in	Annual
India: National Handicrafts Dev. Corp	NHDC	■50K-■10L	Indian artisan enterprises	nhdc.org.in	Rolling
India: Foundation for Indian Contemporary Art	FICA	$1K-$10K	Indian contemporary artists	ficart.org	Annual
Bangladesh: Bengal Foundation Grants	Bengal Foundation	$1K-$10K	Bangladeshi arts and culture	bengalfoundation.org	Annual
Sri Lanka: National Crafts Council	NCC Sri Lanka	LKR 50K-500K	Sri Lankan craft enterprises	nfrcc.lk	Annual
Nepal: Social Welfare Council Culture Grants	SWC Nepal	$1K-$10K	Nepali cultural organisations	swc.org.np	Annual
Pakistan: National Council of the Arts	PNCA	PKR 50K-500K	Pakistani artists and cultural orgs	pnca.org.pk	Annual

Southeast Asia

Fund Name	Org	Amount	Eligibility	Website	Cycle
ASEAN: Culture and Arts Fund	ASEAN Secretariat	$5K-$50K	Cultural organisations in ASEAN member states	asean.org	Annual
Indonesia: Kelola Foundation	Kelola	$2K-$20K	Indonesian arts practitioners	kelola.or.id	Annual
Indonesia: Bakti Budaya Djarum Foundation	Djarum	$5K-$50K	Indonesian cultural heritage projects	dbfrjarum.com	Annual
Philippines: National Commission for Culture and the Arts	NCCA	PHP 50K-500K	Filipino cultural practitioners and orgs	ncca.gov.ph	Annual
Thailand: Office of Contemporary Art and Culture	OCAC	THB 50K-500K	Thai contemporary arts practitioners	ocac.go.th	Annual
Vietnam: Vietnam Foundation for Art Patronage	Various	$1K-$15K	Vietnamese artists and cultural workers	Various	Varies
Malaysia: Cendana (Cultural Economy Dev. Agency)	Cendana	MYR 5K-100K	Malaysian arts and cultural enterprises	cendana.com.my	Multiple cycles

East Asia

Fund Name	Org	Amount	Eligibility	Website	Cycle
Japan: Agency for Cultural Affairs Grants	Bunkacho	¥500K-¥50M	Japanese cultural practitioners and orgs	bunka.go.jp	Annual
Japan: Saison Foundation	Saison	¥500K-¥5M	Japanese contemporary performing arts	saison.or.jp	Annual
Japan: Pola Art Foundation	Pola	¥500K-¥3M	Japanese arts and crafts practitioners	polafr-art.jp	Annual
South Korea: Arts Council Korea (ARKO)	ARKO	KRW 5M-100M	Korean arts practitioners and organisations	arko.or.kr	Multiple cycles
South Korea: Korea Craft and Design Foundation	KCDF	KRW 5M-50M	Korean craft and design enterprises	kcdf.kr	Annual
Taiwan: National Culture and Arts Foundation	NCAF	NTD 100K-3M	Taiwan-based cultural practitioners	ncafrfroc.org.tw	Quarterly
Taiwan: Ministry of Culture Grants	MOC Taiwan	NTD 200K-5M	Taiwan cultural enterprises and orgs	moc.gov.tw	Annual

Pacific Islands

Fund Name	Org	Amount	Eligibility	Website	Cycle
Pacific Islands Forum Culture Fund	PIF	$2K-$20K	Pacific Island cultural practitioners	forumsec.org	Annual
Fiji Arts Council Grants	Fiji Arts Council	FJD 2K-20K	Fiji-based artists and cultural orgs	fijiartscouncil.org.fj	Annual
Creative New Zealand Pacific Arts Fund	CNZ	NZD 5K-75K	Pacific artists in NZ and the Pacific	creativenz.govt.nz	Multiple cycles
Papua New Guinea: National Cultural Commission	NCC PNG	PGK 5K-50K	PNG cultural practitioners and communities	ncc.gov.pg	Annual
Samoa: Ministry of Education Sports and Culture	MESC Samoa	SAT 2K-20K	Samoan cultural practitioners	mesc.gov.ws	Annual

Australia and New Zealand

Fund Name	Org	Amount	Eligibility	Website	Cycle
Australia Council for the Arts	Australia Council	AUD 5K-500K	Australian artists and cultural orgs	australiacouncil.gov.au	Multiple cycles
Creative Victoria	State of Victoria	AUD 5K-100K	Victorian creative enterprises	creative.vic.gov.au	Annual
Create NSW	NSW Govt	AUD 5K-150K	NSW arts and cultural organisations	create.nsw.gov.au	Multiple cycles
Creative New Zealand	CNZ	NZD 5K-150K	NZ artists and cultural organisations	creativenz.govt.nz	Multiple cycles
Te Manatuu Taonga (NZ Heritage)	Heritage NZ	NZD 2K-50K	NZ heritage preservation projects	heritage.org.nz	Annual
First Nations Arts (Australia)	Australia Council	AUD 5K-100K	First Nations Australian artists	australiacouncil.gov.au	Multiple cycles

TIP: In South and Southeast Asia, look beyond government funds. Private foundations such as the India Foundation for the Arts, Kelola in Indonesia, and the Bengal Foundation often have faster application processes and more flexible requirements.

3c. Europe

Europe has the most developed public funding infrastructure for cultural enterprises in the world. The European Union runs continent-wide programmes, while each country maintains its own national and regional arts councils. The key challenge in Europe is not finding funds but navigating the bureaucracy.

EU-Wide Programmes

Fund Name	Org	Amount	Eligibility	Website	Cycle
Creative Europe	European Commission	€50K-€2M	Cultural orgs in EU and associated countries	ec.europa.eu/creative-europe	Annual
Horizon Europe: Culture Cluster	European Commission	€100K-€3M	Research consortia inc. cultural innovation	ec.europa.eu/horizon-europe	Annual
European Cultural Foundation (ECF)	ECF	€5K-€50K	European cultural collaboration projects	culturalfoundation.eu	Multiple cycles
COSME / Single Market Programme	European Commission	€10K-€200K	European creative SMEs	ec.europa.eu	Rolling
European Social Fund: Culture Initiatives	ESF	Varies by country	Cultural training and employment projects	ec.europa.eu/esf	National calls
i-Portunus Mobility Grants	EU / Goethe-Institut	€1.5K-€3K	Individual artists mobility in Europe	i-portunus.eu	Multiple cycles

United Kingdom

Fund Name	Org	Amount	Eligibility	Website	Cycle
Arts Council England (NPO + Project)	ACE	£1K-£100K+	England-based artists and cultural orgs	artscouncil.org.uk	Rolling / Annual
Creative Scotland	Creative Scotland	£1K-£150K	Scotland-based cultural practitioners	creativescotland.com	Rolling / Annual
Arts Council of Wales	ACW	£1K-£100K	Wales-based artists and cultural orgs	arts.wales	Rolling
Arts Council of Northern Ireland	ACNI	£1K-£50K	NI-based cultural practitioners	artscouncil-ni.org	Multiple cycles
British Council: Arts Programmes	British Council	£5K-£50K	International cultural collaboration w/ UK	britishcouncil.org	Varies
Heritage Fund (National Lottery)	Heritage Fund	£3K-£5M	UK heritage preservation projects	heritagefund.org.uk	Rolling
Esmee Fairbairn Foundation: Arts	EFF	£10K-£500K	UK arts organisations	esmeefairbairn.org.uk	Rolling
Paul Hamlyn Foundation: Arts	PHF	£5K-£200K	UK arts organisations and individuals	phf.org.uk	Rolling / Annual
Wellcome Trust: Arts + Health	Wellcome	£5K-£200K	Art-science-health collaborations	wellcome.org	Rolling

Nordics

Fund Name	Org	Amount	Eligibility	Website	Cycle
Nordic Culture Fund	Nordic Council of Ministers	DKK 25K-500K	Cross-Nordic cultural collaboration	nordiskkulturfond.org	Quarterly

Fund Name	Org	Amount	Eligibility	Website	Cycle
Nordic Culture Point	NCP	DKK 10K-200K	Nordic and Baltic cultural mobility	nordiskkulturkontakt.org	Multiple cycles
Swedish Arts Council	Kulturradet	SEK 20K-2M	Swedish cultural practitioners and orgs	kulturradet.se	Multiple cycles
Danish Arts Foundation	Statens Kunstfond	DKK 20K-500K	Danish artists and cultural orgs	kunst.dk	Annual
Arts Promotion Centre Finland (Taike)	Taike	€2K-€50K	Finnish artists and cultural orgs	taike.fi	Annual
Norwegian Arts Council	Kulturradet	NOK 20K-1M	Norwegian cultural practitioners	kulturradet.no	Multiple cycles
Icelandic Centre for Research (RANNIS)	RANNIS	ISK 500K-5M	Icelandic cultural research and innovation	rannis.is	Annual

Western Europe

Fund Name	Org	Amount	Eligibility	Website	Cycle
France: Centre National des Arts Plastiques	CNAP	€5K-€50K	French and France-based artists	cnap.fr	Annual
France: Institut Francais	IF	€5K-€50K	International cultural exchange w/ France	institutfrancais.com	Rolling
Germany: Federal Cultural Foundation	Kulturstiftung des Bundes	€10K-€500K	German-based cultural projects	kulturstiftung-des-bundes.de	Biannual
Germany: Goethe-Institut Grants	Goethe-Institut	€5K-€50K	International cultural exchange w/ Germany	goethe.de	Rolling
Netherlands: Mondriaan Fund	Mondriaan Fund	€5K-€100K	Netherlands-based visual arts and heritage	mondriaanfonds.nl	Multiple cycles
Netherlands: Stimuleringsfonds	Creative Industries Fund NL	€5K-€100K	Dutch creative industries	stimuleringsfonds.nl	Multiple cycles
Belgium: Flanders Arts Institute	Kunstenpunt	€2K-€50K	Flemish cultural practitioners	kunsten.be	Multiple cycles
Spain: Accion Cultural Espanola (AC/E)	AC/E	€5K-€100K	Spanish cultural internationalisation	accioncultural.es	Annual
Italy: Italian Council Fund	DGCC Italy	€20K-€200K	Italian contemporary art promotion abroad	italiancouncil.it	Annual
Portugal: DGArtes	DGArtes	€5K-€100K	Portuguese cultural practitioners and orgs	dgartes.gov.pt	Annual

Eastern Europe and Balkans

Fund Name	Org	Amount	Eligibility	Website	Cycle
Visegrad Fund	International Visegrad Fund	€5K-€70K	Cultural projects in V4 + Eastern partners	vfrisegradfund.org	Multiple cycles
European Cultural Foundation: Balkans	ECF	€5K-€30K	Cultural cooperation in Balkans	culturalfoundation.eu	Annual
Poland: Adam Mickiewicz Institute	AMI	PLN 10K-200K	Polish cultural promotion abroad	iam.pl	Rolling
Romania: AFCN	AFCN	RON 10K-200K	Romanian cultural projects	afcn.ro	Annual

Fund Name	Org	Amount	Eligibility	Website	Cycle
Serbia: Ministry of Culture Grants	Min. of Culture Serbia	RSD 100K-2M	Serbian cultural practitioners	kultura.gov.rs	Annual
Croatia: Kultura Nova Foundation	Kultura Nova	HRK 20K-200K	Croatian civil society cultural orgs	kulturanova.hr	Annual
Bulgaria: National Culture Fund	NCF Bulgaria	BGN 5K-100K	Bulgarian cultural practitioners and orgs	ncf.bg	Annual

WARNING: EU-funded programmes like Creative Europe require partner organisations in multiple countries. If you are a solo cultural entrepreneur, look for lead organisations already forming consortia who need partners. The Creative Europe Desks in each country can help you connect.

3d. Americas

The Americas span an enormous range of funding landscapes, from the well-resourced foundation sector in the United States to emerging cultural enterprise funds across Latin America. Both public and private funding play significant roles.

United States

Fund Name	Org	Amount	Eligibility	Website	Cycle
National Endowment for the Arts (NEA)	NEA	$10K-$100K	US-based arts organisations and artists	arts.gov	Annual
National Endowment for the Humanities	NEH	$10K-$500K	US-based humanities/cultural heritage projects	neh.gov	Annual
Ford Foundation: Creativity and Free Expression	Ford Foundation	$50K-$1M	Organisations advancing cultural expression	fordfoundation.org	Rolling
Andrew W. Mellon Foundation	Mellon	$50K-$5M	Arts, culture, and humanities organisations	mellon.org	By invitation / LOI
Kresge Foundation: Arts and Culture	Kresge	$25K-$500K	US-based arts organisations	kresge.org	Annual
Surdna Foundation: Thriving Cultures	Surdna	$50K-$300K	US arts and cultural organisations	surdna.org	Annual
Doris Duke Foundation: Arts	DDF	$25K-$500K	US performing arts and jazz	dorisduke.org	Various
MAP Fund (Performing Arts)	MAP Fund	$10K-$45K	US performing arts projects	mapfund.org	Annual
Creative Capital	Creative Capital	$10K-$50K	US-based individual artists	creative-capital.org	Annual
Joan Mitchell Foundation	JMF	$25K-$60K	US painters and sculptors	joanmitchellfoundation.org	Annual
South Arts: Cultural Vision Fund	South Arts	$5K-$50K	Southern US cultural organisations	southarts.org	Annual
First Peoples Fund	First Peoples Fund	$5K-$20K	Native American artists and culture bearers	firstpeoplesfund.org	Annual

Canada

Fund Name	Org	Amount	Eligibility	Website	Cycle
Canada Council for the Arts	CCA	CAD 5K-500K	Canadian artists and cultural orgs	canadacouncil.ca	Multiple cycles
Ontario Arts Council	OAC	CAD 5K-150K	Ontario-based artists and orgs	arts.on.ca	Multiple cycles
BC Arts Council	BCAC	CAD 5K-100K	British Columbia cultural practitioners	bcartscouncil.ca	Annual
Conseil des arts du Quebec	CALQ	CAD 5K-200K	Quebec-based cultural practitioners	calq.gouv.qc.ca	Multiple cycles
Alberta Foundation for the Arts	AFA	CAD 3K-75K	Alberta-based artists and orgs	affta.ab.ca	Annual
Canada Heritage: Cultural Spaces Fund	Canada Heritage	CAD 25K-5M	Canadian cultural infrastructure projects	canada.ca/heritage	Annual

Latin America and Caribbean

Fund Name	Org	Amount	Eligibility	Website	Cycle
Mexico: FONCA (now FOCSA)	Secretaria de Cultura Mexico	MXN 50K-500K	Mexican artists and cultural practitioners	fonca.cultura.gob.mx	Annual
Mexico: Fundacion Jumex Arte Contemporaneo	Jumex	$5K-$50K	Mexican contemporary art projects	fundacionjumex.org	Annual
Ibercultura Viva	SEGIB	$5K-$30K	Ibero-American community-based cultural projects	iberculturaviva.org	Annual
Brazil: Rouanet Law (Lei de Incentivo)	Min. of Culture Brazil	Varies	Brazilian cultural projects (tax incentive)	cultura.gov.br	Rolling
Brazil: Funarte	Funarte	BRL 10K-200K	Brazilian arts practitioners	funarte.gov.br	Annual
Colombia: Ministry of Culture Grants	MinCultura Colombia	COP 5M-100M	Colombian cultural practitioners and orgs	mincultura.gov.co	Annual
Argentina: Fondo Nacional de las Artes	FNA	ARS varies	Argentine artists and cultural orgs	ffrna.gob.ar	Multiple cycles
Peru: Ministry of Culture Grants	Min. de Cultura Peru	PEN 5K-100K	Peruvian cultural practitioners	gob.pe/cultura	Annual
Chile: FONDART	FONDART	CLP 1M-20M	Chilean cultural practitioners and orgs	fondosdecultura.cl	Annual
Caribbean: Fresh Milk Art Platform	Fresh Milk	$1K-$10K	Caribbean visual artists	freshmilkbarbados.com	Annual
AECID Cultural Cooperation (Spain-LatAm)	AECID	€5K-€100K	Spain-Latin America cultural cooperation	aecid.es	Annual

TIP: In the US, state arts councils are an underused resource. Every state has one, and many offer grants specifically for cultural heritage and folk arts. Check your state arts council website as a first step. Foundation grants often require a 501(c)(3) status, but fiscal sponsors can provide this if you are an individual or informal group.

3e. Middle East

The Middle East has a growing cultural funding ecosystem, particularly in the Gulf states where cultural diversification is a strategic priority. Traditional arts are valued alongside contemporary innovation, creating opportunities for heritage-based enterprises.

Fund Name	Org	Amount	Eligibility	Website	Cycle
Abu Dhabi Cultural Foundation	DCT Abu Dhabi	$5K-$100K	UAE-based and international cultural projects	culturalfoundation.ae	Annual
Sharjah Art Foundation Grants	SAF	$5K-$50K	International contemporary arts projects	sharjahart.org	Annual
Saudi Arabia: Quality of Life Program (Vision 2030)	Ministry of Culture KSA	SAR varies	Saudi cultural enterprises and projects	moc.gov.sa	Rolling
Saudi Arabia: Ithra (King Abdulaziz Center)	Aramco	SAR varies	Saudi and international cultural practitioners	ithra.com	Annual
Qatar Foundation: Culture and Heritage	QF	$10K-$200K	Cultural heritage projects linked to Qatar	qf.org.qa	Annual
Qatar Museums: Cultural Grants	Qatar Museums	$5K-$100K	Cultural practitioners and projects in Qatar	qm.org.qa	Annual
Oman: Ministry of Heritage and Culture	MHC Oman	OMR 1K-20K	Omani cultural practitioners	mhc.gov.om	Annual
Jordan: Abdulhameed Shoman Foundation	ASF	JOD 1K-20K	Jordanian and Arab arts and culture	shfroman.org	Annual
Lebanon: AFAC (Arab Fund for Arts and Culture)	AFAC	$5K-$50K	Arab artists and cultural organisations	arabculturefund.org	Annual
Lebanon: Al-Mawred Al-Thaqafy	Al-Mawred	$2K-$15K	Arab region cultural mobility and production	mawred.org	Annual
Barjeel Art Foundation (UAE)	Barjeel	$5K-$30K	Arab contemporary art	barfrjeel.org	By invitation
Palestinian: A.M. Qattan Foundation	Qattan	$5K-$50K	Palestinian arts and culture	qattanfoundation.org	Annual
Kuwait: Al-Babtain Foundation	Al-Babtain	$2K-$20K	Arabic poetry and literary culture	albabtainfoundation.org	Annual
Bahrain: Ministry of Culture Grants	Min. of Culture Bahrain	BHD 1K-10K	Bahraini cultural practitioners	moc.gov.bh	Annual

TIP: Gulf state cultural programmes often come with significant infrastructure support beyond cash. Exhibition space, studio access, and marketing through major cultural institutions can be as valuable as the grant itself. When applying, ask about the full package of support available.

3f. International and Multi-Regional

These organisations fund cultural projects regardless of geography, or specifically support cross-border cultural collaboration. If you are working across regions, or if your country has limited domestic funding, these international sources should be your priority.

Fund Name	Org	Amount	Eligibility	Website	Cycle
UNESCO: IFCD	UNESCO	$30K-$100K	Developing country cultural industries	en.unesco.org/creativity/ifcd	Annual
UNESCO: Intangible Cultural Heritage Fund	UNESCO	$25K-$100K	Intangible heritage safeguarding projects	ich.unesco.org	Annual
Prince Claus Fund	Prince Claus Fund	€5K-€25K	Artists and cultural orgs in Africa, Asia, Latin America, Caribbean	princeclausfund.org	Annual
HIVOS: Culture and Civic Space	HIVOS	€10K-€100K	Cultural freedom and creative expression globally	hivos.org	Rolling
Swiss Arts Council Pro Helvetia	Pro Helvetia	CHF 5K-100K	Swiss and international cultural exchange	prohelvetia.ch	Multiple cycles
Ford Foundation: International	Ford Foundation	$50K-$1M+	Global cultural expression and social justice	fordfoundation.org	Rolling
British Council: Global Programmes	British Council	£5K-£100K	International cultural collaboration with UK	britishcouncil.org	Varies
Goethe-Institut: International Co-Productions	Goethe-Institut	€5K-€50K	Cultural projects connecting with Germany	goethe.de	Rolling
Japan Foundation	Japan Foundation	¥500K-¥10M	Cultural exchange with Japan	jpf.go.jp	Annual
Korea Foundation	Korea Foundation	KRW 5M-100M	Cultural exchange with South Korea	kf.or.kr	Annual
Alliance Francaise: Cultural Programs	Alliance Francaise	€2K-€20K	Cultural projects connecting with France	fondation-alliancefr.org	Rolling
Open Society Foundations: Culture	OSF	$10K-$200K	Arts and culture for open societies	opensocietyfoundations.org	Rolling
Rockefeller Foundation: Cultural Innovation	Rockefeller	$50K-$500K	Cultural innovation for social impact	rockefellerfoundation.org	By invitation
Bloomberg Philanthropies: Arts	Bloomberg	$25K-$500K	Arts access and cultural institutions	bloomberg.org	By invitation
Aga Khan Trust for Culture	AKTC	$10K-$500K	Cultural heritage in Muslim societies	akdn.org	By invitation
International Music Council / UNESCO	IMC	$5K-$50K	Music-related cultural projects globally	imc-cim.org	Annual
International Theatre Institute	ITI-UNESCO	$2K-$20K	Theatre and performing arts globally	iti-worldwide.org	Annual
World Crafts Council	WCC	$2K-$20K	Craft practitioners globally	wccinternational.org	Annual
Commonwealth Foundation: Culture	CF	£5K-£50K	Cultural practitioners in Commonwealth countries	commonwealthfoundation.com	Annual
European Bank for Reconstruction (Creative Economies)	EBRD	€10K-€100K	Creative economy enterprises in EBRD regions	ebrd.com	Rolling
Christensen Fund	Christensen	$25K-$200K	Biocultural diversity and indigenous cultural projects	christensenfund.org	LOI / Rolling

Fund Name	Org	Amount	Eligibility	Website	Cycle
Firelight Foundation	Firelight	$5K-$50K	Community-based organisations in Africa	firelightfoundation.org	Annual
Drosos Foundation	Drosos	CHF 50K-300K	Youth livelihood through culture in MENA and Africa	drfrosos.org	Rolling
Robert Bosch Stiftung: Cultural Managers	Bosch	€5K-€30K	Cultural managers internationally	bosch-stiftung.de	Annual

WARNING: Some international funders operate on an invitation-only basis. This means you cannot apply directly, but you can build relationships. Attend their events, follow their social media, connect with past grantees, and when they issue calls for Letters of Interest, be ready.

4. Impact Investors and Social Enterprise Finance

Impact investors put money into enterprises that generate both financial returns and measurable social or cultural impact. For cultural entrepreneurs, this can be a powerful funding source, especially if you are past the startup phase and generating revenue.

What Impact Investors Look for in Cultural Enterprises

- A clear business model with revenue (or a credible path to it)
- Measurable cultural and social impact (not just financial returns)
- A scalable or replicable model (they want to see growth potential)
- Strong leadership and a capable team
- Legal structure that allows investment (often social enterprise, cooperative, or limited company)
- A credible exit or return mechanism (how the investor gets their money back)

Key Impact Investment Firms Interested in Culture

Investor	Geography	Typical Range	Focus	Website
Acumen	Global	$250K-$2M	Cultural enterprises with poverty alleviation impact	acumen.org
Omidyar Network	Global	$500K-$5M	Creative economy platforms and infrastructure	omidyar.com
Resonance	UK / Global	£25K-£2M	Social enterprises including cultural	resonance.ltd.uk
Big Society Capital	UK	£100K-£5M	Social enterprises in the UK	bigsocietycapital.com
Root Capital	Africa, Latin America	$25K-$2M	Agricultural and artisan enterprises	rootcapital.org
Calvert Impact Capital	Global	$100K-$5M	Community development including culture	calvertimpact.org
Bridges Fund Management	UK / Global	£500K-£10M	Social enterprises with impact	bridgesfundmanagement.com
responsAbility	Global	$100K-$2M	Developing market enterprises	responsability.com
Shared Interest	Global / Africa	£10K-£500K	Fair trade and artisan cooperatives	shared-interest.com
Oikocredit	Global	€50K-€5M	Social enterprises in developing countries	oikocredit.coop

Blended Finance Models for Culture

Blended finance combines different types of capital, for example a grant to cover startup costs alongside a loan for equipment, or a mix of philanthropic capital (patient, lower-return) and commercial capital. This approach is particularly well-suited to cultural enterprises that have both social mission and commercial viability.

A practical blended finance model for a cultural enterprise might look like this: A foundation provides a grant of $25,000 for research and product development. A social enterprise lender provides a $50,000 loan at low

interest for equipment and workspace. An impact investor provides $100,000 in exchange for a 15 percent revenue share until they receive 1.5 times their investment back. This structure manages risk at each stage and matches capital type to need.

How to Structure Your Enterprise for Investment Readiness

Most impact investors cannot invest in informal enterprises, sole traders, or unregistered organisations. To be investment-ready, consider the following steps:

- **Legal structure:** Register as a limited company, social enterprise, cooperative, or equivalent in your jurisdiction. Community Interest Companies (CICs) in the UK, benefit corporations in the US, and cooperatives in many countries are investor-friendly structures.
- **Financial records:** Maintain at least 12 months of clean financial records. An investor will want to see revenue, expenses, profit margins, and cash flow.
- **Impact measurement:** Develop a simple impact measurement framework. Use your CIL assessment as a starting point. Investors want to know what impact their money creates.
- **Business plan:** Write a clear, honest business plan that covers your market, revenue model, growth strategy, team, and financial projections for three to five years.
- **Governance:** Establish a board or advisory committee with diverse skills. Investors look for accountability structures beyond a single founder.

TIP: You do not need to be investment-ready to start the conversation. Many impact investors run information sessions, webinars, and accelerator programmes specifically to help enterprises prepare. Attend these and build relationships well before you are ready to pitch.

5. Crowdfunding and Community Finance

Crowdfunding allows you to raise small amounts from many people, usually through an online platform. For cultural entrepreneurs, it offers more than money: it validates demand, builds an audience, and creates a community of supporters who become your first customers and ambassadors.

Global Crowdfunding Platforms

Platform	Website	Best For	Model	Fees
Kickstarter	kickstarter.com	Design, crafts, film, music, publishing	All or nothing (must reach goal)	5% + payment processing
Indiegogo	indiegogo.com	Innovation, creative projects, social good	Flexible or fixed funding	5% + payment processing
GlobalGiving	globalgiving.org	Non-profit cultural and community projects	Verified non-profit required	5% (non-profit)
Kiva	kiva.org	Microloans for entrepreneurs globally	Loan (0% interest to borrower)	No platform fee
Patreon	patreon.com	Ongoing creative work (subscription model)	Monthly membership	5-12% of income
GoFundMe	gofundme.com	Personal and community projects	Keep what you raise	0% platform fee + processing

Region-Specific Platforms

Platform	Website	Region	Focus
M-Changa	mchanga.africa	Africa (esp. Kenya)	Mobile-first fundraising
Thundafund	thundafund.com	South Africa	Creative projects
Milaap	milaap.org	India	Social impact and personal campaigns
Ulule	ulule.com	Europe (esp. France)	Creative and cultural projects
Leetchi	leetchi.com	Europe	Group fundraising
Zomaal	zomaal.com	Middle East	Creative and social projects
Catarse	catarse.me	Brazil	Creative economy projects
Idea.me	idea.me	Latin America	Creative and innovation projects

Tips for Successful Cultural Crowdfunding

• **Tell a compelling story:** Lead with your cultural heritage, not just your product. People back people, not things.

• **Set a realistic goal:** Calculate your actual costs and set your minimum viable target. You can always exceed it.

• **Create irresistible rewards:** Offer exclusive cultural experiences, behind-the-scenes access, or limited editions. Your culture is the reward.

• **Build momentum before launch:** Gather your first supporters (friends, family, community) and ask them to back you on day one. Early momentum attracts more backers.

• **Invest in video:** A short, authentic video showing your craft and telling your story dramatically increases success rates.

• **Update regularly:** Post updates throughout the campaign. Share progress, challenges, and milestones. Transparency builds trust.

Community Finance Models

Beyond online platforms, there are community-based finance models that work particularly well for cultural enterprises rooted in specific places or communities:

Community shares: Members of your community invest small amounts and become co-owners. This model is popular in the UK (Community Benefit Societies) and is growing globally. It creates deep community ownership and loyalty.

Cooperative models: Form a cooperative of cultural producers to share resources, market collectively, and access larger funding. Cooperatives often qualify for funding that individual enterprises cannot access.

Diaspora investment: Cultural communities living abroad often want to invest in enterprises that preserve their heritage. Create structured investment opportunities for diaspora members. Platforms like Homestrings and diaspora-focused investment clubs can facilitate this.

6. Prizes, Competitions, and Accelerators

Prizes and competitions offer cash awards with no repayment and no equity given up. The competition is fierce, but the payoff goes beyond money: visibility, media coverage, networks, and credibility. For cultural entrepreneurs, winning or even being shortlisted for a major prize can transform your trajectory.

Major Cultural Innovation Prizes

Prize Name	Amount	Focus	Cycle
Aga Khan Award for Architecture	$1M (shared)	Architecture honouring Muslim societies	Triennial
UNESCO-Sharjah Prize for Arab Culture	$60K	Arab cultural contribution	Annual
Rolex Awards for Enterprise	CHF 200K	Cultural and environmental innovation	Biennial
Prince Claus Awards	€25K	Cultural practitioners in conflict/poverty zones	Annual
Artes Mundi Prize	£40K	International contemporary art with social reality	Biennial
LOEWE Foundation Craft Prize	€50K	Exceptional craftsmanship globally	Annual
World Craft Council Award of Excellence	Recognition	Craft excellence by region	Annual
International Award for Art Criticism (IAAC)	$5K-$10K	Art criticism and cultural writing	Annual
Creative Business Cup	$20K+ prizes	Creative business startups globally	Annual
European Heritage Awards / Europa Nostra	€10K	Heritage conservation and innovation	Annual
Cartier Women's Initiative	€100K	Women entrepreneurs globally (inc. culture)	Annual
Chivas Venture	$1M (shared)	Social enterprise globally	Annual
SEED Awards	€5K	Social and environmental enterprise	Annual
Africa Prize for Engineering Innovation	£25K	African engineering and design innovation	Annual
Global Art Prize (Various)	Varies	Multiple countries run national prizes	Annual
UNESCO Creative Cities: Call for Projects	Varies	Creative Cities Network members	Annual

Prize Name	Amount	Focus	Cycle
Design Indaba Innovation Award	ZAR varies	African creative innovation	Annual
Jameel Prize (V&A Museum)	£25K	Contemporary art and design inspired by Islamic tradition	Biennial
Latin American Design Award (LADA)	$5K	Latin American design innovation	Annual
Asian Art Prize (Various)	Varies	Asian contemporary art	Annual

Accelerator Programmes for Cultural Enterprises

Accelerators provide intensive support over a fixed period, typically three to six months, including mentoring, training, networking, workspace, and sometimes seed funding. These programmes for cultural enterprises include:

Programme	Geography	Duration	Offers	Website
Hivos Creative Industries	Global	3-6 months	Mentorship + seed funding	hivos.org
British Council Creative Enterprise	Multiple countries	4-6 months	Training + connections	britishcouncil.org
Village Capital: Creative Economy	Global	3 months	Peer selection + investment	vilcap.com
Nest (Artisan Business)	Global	12 months	Artisan supply chain building	buildanest.org
Creative Business Cup Bootcamp	Global	1 week intensive	Pitch preparation	creativebusinesscup.com
NESTA Creative Enterprise Toolkit	UK / Global	Self-paced	Free online toolkit	nesta.org.uk
Unreasonable Group	Global	2 weeks intensive	Growth-stage enterprises	unreasonablegroup.com
MEST Africa	Africa	12 months	Tech and creative entrepreneurs	mfrgest.net
Impact Hub: Cultural Programmes	Global network	3-6 months	Co-working + mentorship	impacthub.net
Creative Startups	US / Global	6 months	Creative economy startups	creativestartups.org

How to Enter Competitions Strategically

- Be selective. Apply only to competitions aligned with your work. A scatter-gun approach wastes time.
- Read past winners carefully. Understand what the judges value before you apply.
- Start with smaller, regional competitions to build your portfolio and confidence.
- Apply early in the cycle, not at the deadline. Some competitions review on a rolling basis.
- Get feedback on applications before submitting. Ask a mentor, peer, or business advisor to review.
- Track every competition in a calendar. Set reminders two months before each deadline.
- Reuse strong application material. Adapt your core pitch for different competitions rather than starting from scratch each time.

7. Application Toolkit

This section gives you ready-to-use templates and frameworks for funding applications. Adapt these to fit each funder's requirements, but use them as your starting structure.

Grant Application Template

Most grant applications ask for the same core information, even if the format varies. Use this template to prepare your content, then adapt it to each funder's form.

1. Organisation Overview (150-250 words)

Who you are, your mission, your cultural heritage focus, how long you have been operating, your key achievements, and your legal structure.

2. Project Description (300-500 words)

What you want to do with the funding. Be specific: activities, timeline, location, and who will be involved. Describe the cultural significance of the project.

3. Need and Rationale (200-300 words)

Why this project matters now. What problem does it solve? What opportunity does it seize? Use data and evidence where possible.

4. Beneficiaries (150-200 words)

Who benefits from this project? Direct beneficiaries (artisans, community members) and indirect beneficiaries (cultural heritage, local economy). Be specific about numbers.

5. Methodology (200-300 words)

How you will carry out the project. Your approach, methods, and the rationale for choosing them. Include any community consultation processes.

6. Impact and Outcomes (200-300 words)

What changes will result from this project? Use the CIL framework: Cultural Capital preserved or built, Innovation Activities enabled, Organisational Capacities strengthened, Economic Resilience created.

7. Sustainability (100-200 words)

How will the impact continue after the funding ends? What revenue model, partnerships, or structures ensure long-term viability?

8. Budget Summary (see budget template below)

A clear, justified budget with line items explained.

9. Team (100-150 words)

Who will carry out the work? Their qualifications and experience. Include cultural credentials, not just formal education.

Budget Template for Cultural Projects

Cultural projects have unique cost categories that generic templates miss. Use this template to capture the true cost of your cultural work.

Budget Category	Description	Amount
Personnel	Project coordinator, admin support	[Enter]
Master Artisan / Elder Fees	Consultation, knowledge-sharing, teaching	[Enter]
Apprentice Stipends	Payments to learners during training	[Enter]
Raw Materials	Cultural materials, natural dyes, fibres, clay, etc.	[Enter]
Equipment and Tools	Traditional and modern tools needed	[Enter]
Community Consultation	Meeting costs, facilitator fees, travel for consultations	[Enter]
Cultural IP Licensing	Permissions, benefit-sharing, protocols	[Enter]
Documentation	Photography, video, written records of process	[Enter]
Travel and Transport	Site visits, market visits, supplier travel	[Enter]
Marketing and Sales	Photography, website, market stall fees, packaging	[Enter]
Venue / Workspace	Rent, utilities, workshop space	[Enter]
Training and Capacity Building	Skills development, digital literacy, business training	[Enter]
Monitoring and Evaluation	Data collection, impact assessment, reporting	[Enter]
Contingency (5-10%)	Unforeseen costs	[Enter]
TOTAL		[Enter]

TIP: Always include a budget narrative that explains each line item. Funders want to know WHY you need each expense, not just what it costs. For cultural-specific items like master artisan fees, explain the cultural significance: 'Master artisan fees compensate knowledge holders for sharing techniques passed down through five generations.'

Common Mistakes That Get Cultural Applications Rejected

• **Being too vague about impact:** Saying 'we will preserve culture' is not enough. Specify: 'We will document 12 traditional techniques, train 20 apprentices, and create 3 new market-ready products.'

• **Underbudgeting:** Cultural entrepreneurs routinely undervalue their time and cultural expertise. If your budget looks suspiciously cheap, funders will doubt your ability to deliver.

• **Ignoring the funder's priorities:** Read the call guidelines carefully. If they prioritise youth engagement and you do not mention young people, you will be filtered out.

• **No evidence of community support:** For cultural projects, funders want to know the community is behind you. Include letters of support, community consultation evidence, or partnership commitments.

• **Weak sustainability plan:** 'We will seek more grants' is not a sustainability plan. Show how the project creates lasting value: revenue streams, trained people, documented knowledge, community ownership.

• **Missing deadlines:** Late is late. Set calendar reminders for every deadline, with a two-week buffer for review and refinement.

• **Copying and pasting without adapting:** Funders can tell when you have sent the same generic application. Customise every submission to reflect the funder's language, values, and priorities.

12-Month Funding Calendar Template

Use this template to plan your funding activities across the year. Fill in specific deadlines as you identify opportunities from this guide.

Month	Actions
January	Review annual goals. Identify Q1 grant deadlines. Draft applications for Q1 opportunities.
February	Submit Q1 applications. Research Q2 opportunities. Begin impact data collection from previous grants.
March	Submit remaining Q1 applications. Start Q2 drafts. Attend networking events for funder contacts.
April	Submit Q2 applications. Review and report on current grants. Update financial records.
May	Mid-year review: which applications succeeded? Adjust strategy. Research crowdfunding timing.
June	Submit Q2 applications. Begin Q3 research. Update your CIL assessment scores.
July	Launch crowdfunding campaign (if planned). Prepare Q3 applications. Attend summer pitch events.
August	Continue crowdfunding. Submit Q3 applications. Network at festivals and trade fairs.
September	Review crowdfunding results. Begin Q4 planning. Update business plan with new data.
October	Submit Q4 applications. Prepare year-end reports for existing funders.
November	Submit final Q4 applications. Begin next year planning. Update this funding guide.
December	Year-end reporting. Thank funders and stakeholders. Set goals and targets for next year.

8. Appendices

Appendix A: Glossary of Funding Terms

Blended Finance: A combination of different types of capital (grants, loans, equity) in a single funding package.

Call for Proposals: A formal announcement by a funder inviting organisations to apply for a specific funding opportunity.

Co-Funding: When multiple funders contribute to the same project, or when the applicant matches funding with their own resources.

Due Diligence: The investigation process an investor or funder conducts before committing money.

Eligibility Criteria: The requirements an applicant must meet to qualify for a funding opportunity.

Equity: Ownership shares in a company. Equity investors receive a portion of ownership in exchange for capital.

Fiscal Sponsor: A registered organisation that manages grant funds on behalf of an individual or unregistered group.

Grant: Non-repayable funds provided for a specific purpose, usually with reporting requirements.

Impact Measurement: The process of assessing the social, cultural, and environmental effects of a project or enterprise.

In-Kind Support: Non-cash contributions such as workspace, equipment, mentoring, or materials.

Letter of Intent (LOI): A short preliminary proposal that a funder uses to determine if a full application is worth requesting.

Logic Model: A visual framework showing the relationship between resources, activities, outputs, outcomes, and impact.

Match Funding: A requirement that the applicant must raise additional funds to match the grant amount.

Revenue-Based Finance: An investment repaid as a percentage of future revenue until a set amount is returned.

Seed Funding: Initial capital to start a project or enterprise, usually the first external money received.

Social Enterprise: A business that prioritises social or cultural impact alongside financial sustainability.

Theory of Change: A description of how and why a desired change is expected to happen in a particular context.

Appendix B: Regulatory Notes for Receiving International Grants

Receiving international funding can involve regulatory requirements in your home country. Here are key considerations for major regions:

India: International grants must be received through the FCRA (Foreign Contribution Regulation Act) route. Organisations need FCRA registration or must use a registered intermediary. Processing can take months.

Nigeria: Register with the Corporate Affairs Commission (CAC) and ensure compliance with the Money Laundering (Prevention) Act for large international transfers.

Kenya: NGOs receiving international funds must register with the NGO Coordination Board. For-profit social enterprises have fewer restrictions but should consult tax advisors.

South Africa: Non-profit organisations (NPOs) must be registered and comply with the NPO Act. International funding may trigger reporting requirements under the Financial Intelligence Centre Act.

Brazil: International donations must comply with Central Bank regulations. Use of the Rouanet Law (tax incentive) has specific compliance requirements.

Mexico: Organisations receiving international grants must be registered with the SAT (Tax Administration Service) and comply with anti-money-laundering regulations.

United Kingdom: Charities must report overseas income to the Charity Commission. Trading activities may require a separate trading subsidiary.

European Union: VAT implications vary by country for international grants. Some grants are VAT-exempt while others are not. Consult a local accountant.

> **WARNING:** Tax and regulatory compliance for international grants is complex and varies by country. Always consult a local accountant or legal advisor before accepting large international grants. The cost of professional advice is far less than the cost of non-compliance.

Appendix C: Template — Letter of Support from Community Leaders

Adapt this template for your specific context. A letter of support from a recognised community leader significantly strengthens grant applications for cultural projects.

[Date]

[Funder Name and Address]

Dear [Funder Contact Name],

I am writing in my capacity as [Title/Role] of [Community/Organisation Name] to express my strong support for the application submitted by [Applicant Name/Organisation] for [Grant Programme Name].

[Applicant Name] has been an active and valued member of our community for [number] years. Their work in [brief description of cultural work] has contributed significantly to [specific cultural benefit: preservation of traditional techniques, employment of local artisans, documentation of cultural heritage, etc.].

The proposed project, [project title], is important to our community because [reason: it will preserve endangered techniques, create youth employment, strengthen cultural identity, etc.]. Our community has been consulted about this project through [describe consultation process: community meetings, elder councils, etc.] and we endorse both the approach and the goals.

We are committed to supporting this project through [describe community contribution: volunteer time, access to cultural sites, participation in documentation, etc.].

I am available to discuss this further at your convenience.

Yours sincerely,

[Name]
[Title/Role]
[Organisation/Community]
[Contact Information]

Appendix D: Template — Cultural Impact Statement

Use this framework to articulate the cultural impact of your enterprise or project. Many funders request this as part of their application process.

Cultural Heritage Preserved: Describe which specific cultural traditions, techniques, or knowledge systems your work protects. Be specific about what would be at risk without your intervention.

Knowledge Transferred: How many people have learned traditional skills through your enterprise? How many master practitioners are actively teaching? What documentation exists?

Cultural Products Created: What new products or services have been developed that honour and extend your cultural heritage? How do they balance innovation with integrity?

Community Benefit: How many people in your cultural community benefit directly from your enterprise's activities? Include employment, income, skill development, and cultural pride.

Cultural Visibility: How has your work increased the visibility and appreciation of your cultural heritage? Include exhibitions, media coverage, awards, and public engagement.

Sustainability: How does your enterprise contribute to the long-term sustainability of your cultural tradition? What structures are in place to ensure continuity?

This guide was created by the Cultural Innovation Lab to support cultural entrepreneurs worldwide in accessing the funding they deserve. Your cultural knowledge has economic value. Your heritage is an asset. And the world needs what you create.

Visit **culturalinnovationlab.org** to take your CIL Assessment and unlock personalised recommendations based on your cultural enterprise profile.

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